CACTUS FALL 2026 · WEEK 8 · BEFORE PRESENTATION DAY

Reproduce and present

A result you cannot rerun is a claim, not a finding.

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WHY THIS WEEK

A result nobody can rerun is a claim

Hidden state

Your notebook remembers cells you deleted and orders you ran by hand. A fresh runtime does not.

Local paths and keys

A path on your laptop breaks for everyone else. A key in a notebook is already shared.

Unwritten choices

Which data, which model, which date, which threshold. If it is not written down, it cannot be checked.

In this deck: how to rerun from scratch, a checklist, how to say what you can claim, and how to present it in six minutes.

THE TEST

Restart and run all

```
Runtime → Restart session and run all

# The first error is the finding.
NameError: name 'clean' is not defined
FileNotFoundError: /Users/aisha/Documents/posts.csv
```

Do it from a fresh runtime, top to bottom, and then have **someone else** do it, with only the notebook and your README. Whatever breaks is what your reader would have hit.

THE CHECKLIST

Before you share the link

Runs

Restart and run all works. Paths are relative. Packages are installed in the notebook.

Safe

No keys, passwords or private data, in the code or in the saved outputs. Keys live in Colab Secrets.

Documented

A data card, your verification log, and a short README that says how to rerun it, how long it takes, and the model and date for any AI step.

If a key was ever pushed, **replace it**. Deleting the file does not remove it from the history.

WHAT YOU CAN CLAIM

Say what it shows, and what it does not

```
In [this sample], [this method] found [this result].
I checked it by [this check].
This does not show [this limit]: [what would make it wrong].
```

Your sample, your check, your limit. Tune on one set and score a different one once. One platform is not every platform. A check you can show is stronger than a number you cannot explain.

IF YOU PRESENT: SIX MINUTES

Four parts, three or four slides

1. Question

Your case study and main question in a sentence. What changed since Week 1.

2. Data

Where it came from, how many rows, what one row is, what you left out.

3. Method and check

What you did, and the check that told you it worked.

4. Result and limits

What you found, how sure you are, what you would not claim.

Public or de-identified data only. Showing the check matters more than a big result. Two minutes of questions follow.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Before Jan 19, then presentations

Swap and rerun

Share your repository link. A partner reruns your notebook from a fresh runtime, using the rerun report.

Share the report

Send your partner the rerun report. The owner fixes what broke before presentation day.

Presentation day

Only presentations, and they are optional: the first five to sign up, six minutes each plus questions.

Rerun on the shared or de-identified sample only. Never ask for private raw data.

QUESTIONS

What would break first?

If a stranger reran your notebook tomorrow, what would break first, and what is the one line in your README that would fix it?